MOUNTAIN REVIEW

OFFICIAL NEWSLETTER OF THE MOUNTAIN VIEW HISTORICAL ASSOCIATION

Volume XIV Issue III Fall 2024



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Look up! Amazing Art in Mountain View



Our Fall 2024 Event

The colorful "Boy and Girl playing in the cala lilies field" in the Civic Center Plaza is viewed by hundreds of people each day.

Join us for...The History of Public Art in Mountain View

The subject of the next history event on November 3 has a more contemporary context, but is something that is around us every day—Public Art. The term public art refers to art that is in the public realm, regardless of whether it is situated on public or private property or whether it has been purchased with public or private money. Whether publicly or privately owned, Mountain View has art pieces with interesting stories of creation and location.

According to several arts organizations "Monuments, memorials, and civic statues and sculptures are the most established forms of public art, but public art can also be transitory, in the form of performances, dance, theatre, poetry, and posters." Many monuments and sculptures have been designed by renowned artists and are easily viewed.

Probably the most recognizable piece of public art in the United States is the Statue of Liberty. It was designed by French sculptor Frederic Auguste Bartholdi. The statue was a gift of the French people and was dedicated on October 28, 1886.

In 1989 the City of Mountain View established the Visual Arts Committee to enrich the City spirit through public art and related community programs. Since the formation of the Visual Arts program over 40 public art pieces have been installed in locations throughout Mountain View. For new buildings constructed by the city a small percentage of the budget is allocated for public art on the property. Many local developments and businesses have also made publicly viewed art available in the community.

The city's website: states "The City's Public Art program is dedicated to supporting local artists and enhancing the everyday experiences of Mountain View residents and visitors. By transforming public spaces into open-air galleries, the program fosters a vibrant and creative community atmosphere." There are several pieces in Mountain View that are easily recognized. Located in front of the library, the Berlin wall segments are both artistic and informative. On the city's website is an interactive map detailing where public and private art is located. https://econdev.mountainview.gov/public-art/map

The locations of 42 publicly owned and over 60 privately owned art pieces are identified. Presenting information at the event will be — Jonathan Clark, an early member of the Visual Arts committee; Susi Merhar of the Visual Arts Committee and Kirstin Hinds from the city. A representative of Google will describe the artwork surrounding the building. For those interested, an optional tour of the artwork will be offered.

Please join us November 3 at 2 pm at the Google Gradient visitor Experience. Located at 2000 N Shoreline Blvd in Mountain View, parking is available at the Amphitheater just north of the building. There is no cost to attend.

Sunday, November 3, 2024 ● 2:00 p.m. ● Google Gradient Visitor Experience, 2000 N. Shoreline Blvd, Mt. View

REGISTER ONLINE: http://mvhistory.eventbrite.com

MOUNTAIN REVIEW

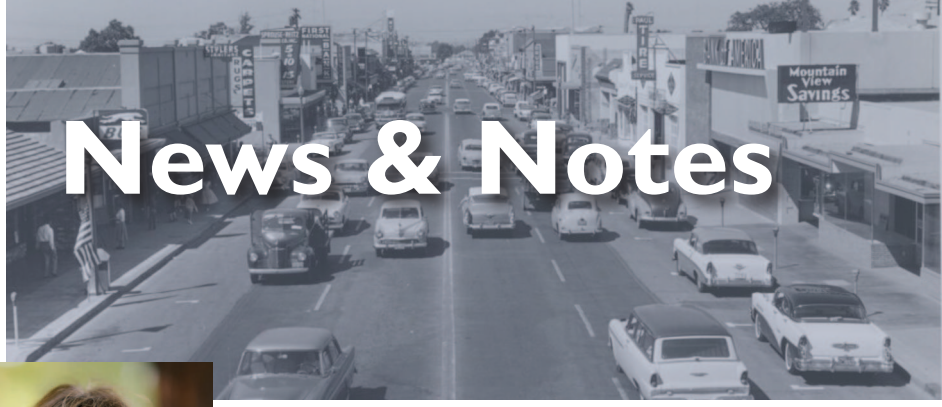
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News & Notes


Pamela Baird

President's Message

By Pamela Baird
MVHA President

Art beneath your feet


Prague

A number of years ago while traveling in Europe (I don't remember which city) I looked down and was enchanted by the design on the manhole cover, which was located in the middle of a cobble stone street. It was the crest of the city— a great way to express pride and showcase the local history.

Since then, whenever we travel, I watch for designs on manhole covers. Usually, the manhole covers in the older areas (and more frequently seen by tourists) of the city will showcase the decorative covers. But even the small but prosperous maritime city of Barth, Germany (from which my paternal great grandparents emigrated) has the city crest on the manhole covers.


Barth, Germany

The manhole (or maintenance hole) covers are a part of the sewer or utilities system of a city. These covers protect the access opening into these necessary systems. The round shape prevents the cover from falling into the hole (a square cover could do this if not placed properly). A cover weighs about 100 pounds, which keeps them in place when traffic passes over them. Usually, the cover is made from cast iron. The covers frequently feature "pick holes," into which a hook handle tool is inserted to lift them.



Palo Alto, CA

Some cities in the US include a crest on the covers, like our neighbor, Palo Alto. In looking around Mountain View, I haven't seen anything other than the name of the foundry or a dimpled pattern (so they aren't slippery in wet weather). There are a few in the North Bayshore area that feature the word "Google" on them.


Japan

The country of Japan has taken manhole cover artwork to an entirely different level. About 95% of the manhole covers in Japan feature decorative art of history, creatures, landscapes or stories. Often these are painted, which adds another layer of fun and detailing.

Wouldn't it be great if the city of Mountain View could do the same? The city crest or logo could be incorporated (whether painted or plain) in the cover. How much more expensive would that be? Anyone interested in advocating for this effort?

Who is Mountain View's Superager?



The search for the oldest resident of Mountain View has concluded.

Board member Carol Donahue, who has organized this outreach effort, reports that she is interviewing Gold, Silver and Bronze finalists in our senior Olympics. They include people born in 1920, 1922 and 1923. MVHA will announce its decision soon. Exercise, loving relationships, hard work, love of nature, and resilience are common threads of their longevity. Our elders are living what science is telling us to do now to live to enjoy a long life.

Watch the next newsletter for stories about these superagers.

Financial Report

By Melissa Rusch *MVHA Treasurer*

Checking Account Balance as of M/D/24: $17, 063.81
Certificates of Deposit: $62,057.21

Membership Report

By Lisa Garcia *MVHA Membership Chair*

We encourage you to keep your membership current. As a courtesy, we may continue to send people the electronic or paper newsletter. However, this does not mean that your membership is current.

MVHA relies on membership dues to cover the cost of insurance, newsletter publication, history event costs and outreach efforts. You can renew through the website or by returning the form shown in this newsletter.

Board Elections 2024

Per our by-laws, every two years four positions are elected by the members attending the fall November 3 event. Those positions are — president, vice president, secretary, and treasurer and form the Executive Committee. Nominations may also be made from the floor at the annual meeting November 3.

Additional board positions are appointed by the executive committee in the December Board meeting. The MVHA encourages and welcomes interested members to get involved with our Board. If you are interested in serving on the board, please contact: info@mountainviewhistorical.org by the end of October.

Community Happenings

— with MVHA (2024 Fall)

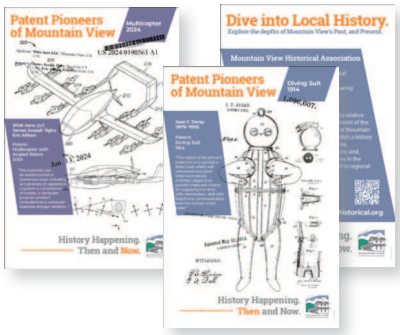
FALL WINTER

Members of the MVHA board of directors have been busy attending community events. Over the past five months we have participated in numerous neighborhood social gatherings and ice cream socials. We have enjoyed talking to people in the following neighborhoods-Old Mountain View, Monta Loma, Cuesta Park, Shoreline West, Varsity Park and Wagon Wheel.



Robert Cox and Ida Rose Sylvester at the Mercy-Bush Park Ice Cream Social

In July we participated for the first time in the Technology Showcase. Presented by the Chamber of Commerce and held in the Civic Center Plaza, the event was a great way to interact with participants having varied interests. IdaRose Sylvester, Neil Hendin, Pamela Baird, Greg Unangst and Melanie Kaye conducted research about patents holders of Mountain View. The group was surprised about how much information was learned about early patents holders. Melanie created wonderful graphics explaining various patents.



MVHA participated in the Volunteer Fair held at the Community Center August 24. Melanie Kaye and Pamela Baird spoke to many people about MVHA and the volunteer opportunities available with our organization.



Melanie Kaye and Pamela Baird at the Volunteer Fair

The Fall Harvest Festival held at Heritage Park September 21 was a fun event for the board. Interested members of the community asked questions about the origins of agriculture and how the area grew rapidly between 1950-1960. The Festival was well attended with many families visiting.



Pamela Baird and Carol Donahue at Heritage Park

Walking tours of downtown Mountain View continue to be a popular outreach effort. The tours are conducted on the fourth Sunday of most months. In both May and June, fifteen people participated in the two hour walk.

The next tours are scheduled for November 24 and December 22. The tours will be listed on our website and on EventBrite. Registration is required.

Upcoming Walking tours of downtown Mountain View November 24 and December 22.

Palmita Park Celebrates Centennial

100 YEARS MARKED WITH BOOK AND 1920s THEMED CELEBRATION

— Kyle Hartzell and Melanie Kaye *Photos: Cherylle Goebel*

2024 marks 100 years since the creation of Palmita Park in Old Mountain View. The original subdivision included Loreto, Anza, and Velarde Street. Palmita Park was the brainchild of Earl Minton, owner of the Minton Lumber Company, a creative and effective businessman, who understood that the housing boom in the early 1920s offered a prime opportunity to expand his business as a lumber merchant.

In the two decades preceding 1920, the Santa Clara Valley attracted great numbers of immigrants, drawn by the familiar mild climate and land available for cultivation.

These families put down roots in Mountain View, joining a growing middle class with a desire for single family homes.

Affordable house plan catalogs, touting the modern efficiency of built-ins in the new 5-room house became available. This new 'bungalow' presented ways to include classical architectural styles at an affordable price.

Earl Minton and B.W. Holeman, local bank president, purchased a tract of land adjacent to Mountain View and subdivided it. They would market these properties, including a clause that all building supplies for homes built on them must be purchased through what was then known as The Minton Company. Minton provided a book of house plans that home buyers could use or customize.





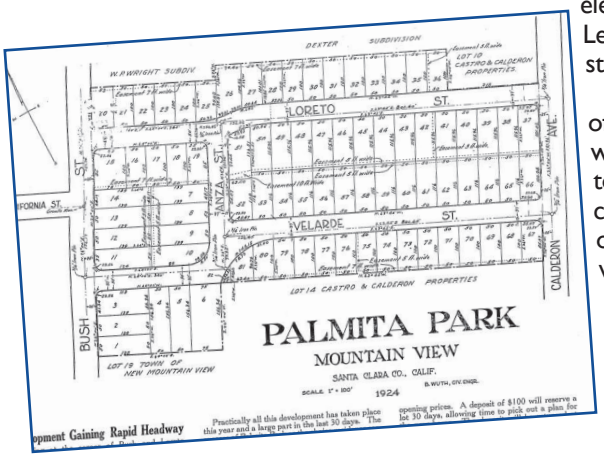
Original ad for S.A. Chappell's Palmita Park home, and a 1926 photo, from his granddaughter, Ms Joann Steiger The house appears today just as it did in 1926.

A contest was held to name the subdivision in 1924. Mrs. C. E. Kunze won the $25 prize with her entry of Palmita Park, which was selected for the little palms planted along the tree lawns, and because it was "peculiar, fitting, and easy to remember."

Building began on Loreto St., with the first home built for Alfred Olson, treasurer of the Minton Company. The large white home at 398 Loreto was another notable early build for Mr. S.A. Chappell, the local druggist.

Palmita Park was highly advertised in the Mountain View Register-Leader, a local paper, touting many modern conveniences, including the placement of electrical and sewer lines along an easement at the back of the properties, meant to beautify the street. While initial plans for the subdivision show two curved streets that were included for aesthetic reasons, Velarde Street later lost its curve in favor of making California a through-street. It became Mountain View's first parkway, featuring a strip of land running up the middle of Velarde between Bush and Anza, distinguished by oak trees and electroliers (streetlights). The Register-Leader referred to this plan as "big city stuff."

Most of Loreto Street and parts of Velarde between Bush and Anza were completed before 1929. Velarde to the north of Anza was primarily completed in the late 1930s. Homes on Velarde from Anza to Calderon were built later.





Melanie Kaye (left) and Kyle Hartzell celebrate finishing their book, Palmita Park The First 100 Years

In 2023, neighbors on Loreto Street petitioned the city to replace the little palms, after several were lost during winter storms. Residents appreciated that the city purchased and planted palm trees to maintain the historical street of Little Palms.

The Centennial Celebration

A celebration commemorating the Palmita Park centennial was held on Loreto Street Saturday, September 21, 2024.



MVHA President, Pamela Baird and Greg Unangst visit Palmita Park in their 1924 best

The festivities opened with an informative history walking tour, led by Melanie Kaye and Kyle Hartzell, authors of Palmita Park | The First 100 Years. The tour was capped off with a champagne toast to the next 100 years.

(Continued on page 6)

Finding Your Family History

by Robert Cox, MVHA Vice President

Tracing Your Paternal Line With Y-DNA Testing

Most people who have taken DNA test from a popular testing service like Ancestry, MyHeritage, or 23 & Me have taken an autosomal DNA test. This kind of test matches all a person's chromosomes with others who have taken the same test and have repeated sequences of DNA in common on one of more chromosomes. Such tests are relatively inexpensive and are good at identifying people who have a common ancestor within the last 4-6 generations. If you are stuck advancing past a brick wall on some ancestral line, finding a DNA cousin who shares a common ancestor with you on that line and has records that document it can help you make new progress.

But is there any hope of getting back past those 4-6 generations on any family line? For males there is! This is because each male has a Y-chromosome which is passed down generally unchanged from his father to him. But every couple hundred years or so, there is a mutation in that Y-chromosome. Genetic genealogists have tracked these mutations and used them to construct migration maps. By taking a Y-DNA test and matching the result these migration maps, you can determine what path your paternal ancestors took out of East Africa (the birthplace of genetic ADAM) to their more recent homelands.



Here is the migration map for my paternal line. It starts in East Africa, goes through the Middle East, and the passes through what is now Turkey into Europe.

Personalized migration maps are provided by Family Tree DNA for those who take one of their Y-DNA tests. These tests are somewhat more expensive than the common autosomal tests, usually about $119. Family Tree DNA also supports DNA projects for people with specific or similar surnames. The Cox group has 1145 members who share each other's DNA tests to find common ancestors.

Note that females can also find their paternal migration maps if their brother, paternal uncle, or paternal grandfather will take a Y-DNA test.

Mountain View Family History Spotlight

Former Mayor Ronit (Shamgar) Bryant's family history is filled with international travel, punctuated with moments of tragedy. Ronit's father's family lived in the Ukraine and Rumania. Like many Europeans of Jewish descent, Ronit's paternal grandparents were victims of the Holocaust, dying in German concentration camps.

In the 1930s, Ronit's father and mother both immigrated to what is now Israel, but at the time was the British mandate in Palestine. Ronit's father had a gift for foreign languages, a gift Ronit inherited. As a young man in World War II, he enlisted in the British navy and became a British liaison officer on an Italian ship. Once Israel became an independent state, he joined the Israeli army and later served in the Israeli foreign service.

Ronit was born in Jerusalem in 1951. When she was a young girl, her family lived in many countries, including Poland, France, Israel, Brazil, and Italy. Ronit remembers her time in Rome, Italy, as one of the bright spots of her youth.

Ronit met her future husband Cliff Bryant while Cliff was teaching English in Israel. Cliff was Ronit's first and only great love. The couple came to the Bay Area when Cliff decided to pursue a career in computing. Ronit and Cliff raised their three children, Yonatan, Astra, and Kira here in Mountain View. The children now live in the Chicago and Seattle areas.

On almost any day of the week, you can see Cliff and Ronit together, walking their dog along the streets of Old Mountain View. While many retire from public life after being mayor, Ronit has continued to serve our city on the Parks and Recreation Commission, advocating for parks, open space, and the preservation of our heritage trees. I continue to be inspired by one of the bumper stickers on Ronit's car, which proclaims "Democracy is not a spectator sport." Above all, Ronit has been a community leader who has lived her values.

Palmita Park Celebrates 100 Years

(Cont. from Page 4)



Photos courtesy: Cherylle Goebel

Flappers and their Champagne fountain(from left) Palmita Park neighbors,Ofelia Seymour, Becca Swett, Katie Tucker and Kait Ball



Palmita Park residents (from left) Andreas and Lucas Goebel, Roger Kaye, Lenny "Bugsy" Siegel and Eugene Cordero contemplate their new home purchase in 1925

Twenties attire was worn by guests including Melanie Kaye, in her original great grandmother's dress. Live music, and 1920s inspired decor, were all made possible by Loreto residents, who also brought appetizers, desserts and even creative, era-inspired Cocktails and Mocktails offered at the Speakeasy bar.

Special guests were Pamela Baird, MVHA President and her husband, Greg Unangst, along with Robert Cox, MVHA vice president and OMVNA Vice Chair, Steering Committee.

Palmita Park The First 100 Years, by Melanie Kaye and Kyle Hartzell, will be available soon in the History Room at the library. The book provides a comprehensive look at one of Mountain View's historically preserved central neighborhoods, including details of both interior and exterior architectural elements and styles. Walking Loreto and Velarde today there are many visible examples of the original Bungalow designs that lined the street in the 1920s and 1930s. Even as the homes in Palmita Park are modernized over time, many of them still retain details of craftsmanship and charm that initially drew buyers a hundred years ago. Many occupants have worked to preserve reminders of the distinct character of this historical neighborhood they love, originally known as Palmita Park.



Kyle Hartzell and Melanie Kaye share Palmita Park history with MVHA Vice President, Robert Cox



Waving to the Eisenhowers on the train

Last year the MVHA received an email from Richard and Carol Kutsch, brother and sister, who lived with their parents in Mountain View in the 1950s —1980s. The two recounted an exciting event for the two siblings—waving at the train carrying Dwight Eisenhower ("Ike")the president of the United States, and his wife Mamie.

The Republican Convention was held at the Cow Palace in San Francisco August 20-23, 1956. The incumbent President and his vice president, Richard Nixon, were nominated to run for another term. Afterwards the President and his wife decided to travel by train to Carmel so that the President could play golf at Pebble Beach.



The Kutsch Family in 1956 (Left to right) Richard, Carol, Kathryn and Robert

The sibling's father, Robert E. Kutsch, was Art Director of the Pacific Press Publishing Association, which was located at 1350 Villa Street, Mountain View. Their facility spread out for four blocks alongside the railroad tracks. Their father learned when the presidential train entourage would be traveling through Mountain View on the Southern Pacific line. The family decided to park in one of the Pacific Press lots hoping to catch a glimpse of the train as it passed through town.

As the two recount "Dad parked our 1950 maroon Studebaker Champion sedan on a vacant PPPA lot at its west end and we all waited for the train. Eventually it came and passed with no indication of the Eisenhowers. When the last observation car passed--there on the rear platform stood both Ike and Mamie! Mom sat in the right front passenger seat. Dad sat behind the driver's wheel. My sister Carol stood on the right front fender holding an old mop handle with paper confetti attached. I stood on the left front fender similarly outfitted. We also had an "I Like Ike" sign. Our parents waved out their windows, and Carol and I both waved. Ike and Mamie both replied with good smiles and waved back! Wow!"

Dwight and Mamie planned to stay in Carmel for four days of vacation and golfing. But the typical cool and foggy weather dampened their enthusiasm to stay the entire time. Their visit was shortened to three days.

U.S. Presidents who have passed through Mountain View



—Pamela Baird with research assistance from Alisha Faraz

Because this is a presidential election year, we thought it would be interesting to research the history of presidents who have passed through Mountain View via the railroad or landed at Moffett Field on their way to other endeavors. Because of the location of these strategic assets, many presidents have viewed our city and surrounding areas.

Compiled below is a list of the documented travels of US Presidents through our lovely community. Not every visit is documented here. Shown in chronological order:

May 14, 1901: William McKinley President McKinley traveled on a nationwide tour to celebrate his election. He made an appearance at a festival in San Jose, having traveled on the train to and from San Francisco. His wife became ill, so he stayed a few more days and traveled again to San Jose. President McKinley would have viewed downtown Mountain View four times. He was assassinated four months later.

August 24, 1956: Dwight Eisenhower President Eisenhower traveled by train from San Francisco to Monterey and back on the train for a golf outing after the Republican Convention.

Bill Clinton President Clinton landed at Moffett Field at least 16 times. His daughter, Chelsea, attended Stanford from 1997-2001, so some of his visits incorporated a personal aspect as well. The visits were for both fundraising and official events.

Barack Obama President Obama landed at least six times at Moffet. His trips were a combination of official visits and fundraising efforts.

September 17, 2019: Donald Trump President Trump landed at Moffett Field for a fund raiser in Portola Valley.

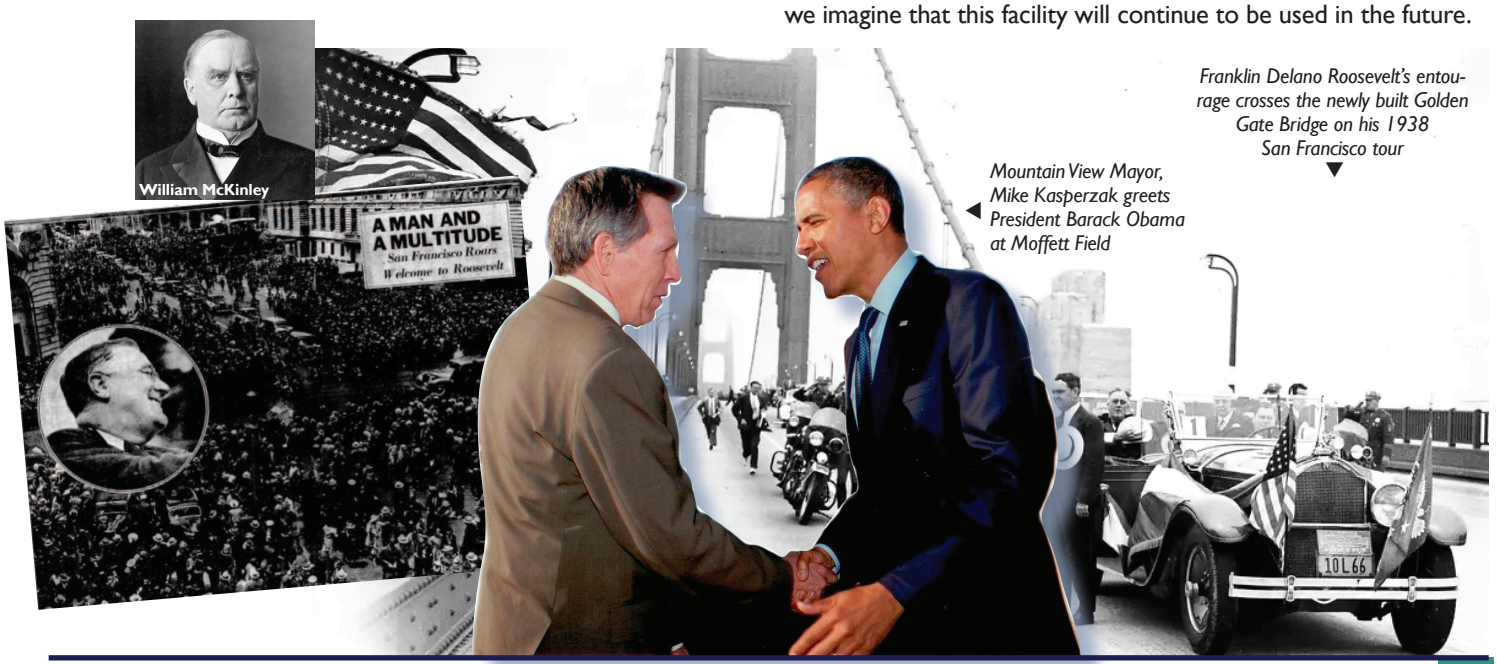
January 19, 2023: Joe Biden President Biden landed at Moffet Field to view storm damage in Santa Cruz.

Even though two presidents visited nearby Stanford and San Francisco and *didn't* pass through Mountain View, their visits had an impact on our residents, nonetheless.

November 8, 1932: Herbert Hoover President Hoover traveled to Stanford, where he maintained a home, to vote in the 1932 election and to await the results. The Mountain View Register Leader newspaper reported that many Santa Clara County schools, including those in Mountain View, were closed in time for children and others to observe him casting his vote in the Stanford Post Office.

July 14, 1938: Franklin Roosevelt President Roosevelt visited the Bay Area on a multi-stop trip. A half-million spectators lined the streets of San Francisco as Roosevelt and his motorcade paraded from the Golden Gate to the Civic Center. According to the Mountain View Register Leader newspaper, residents of Mountain View traveled to San Francisco to join the crowds hoping to see the president. To avoid a long day, one resident even stayed the night with her sister.

Mike Kasperzak, Ronit Bryant, Chris Clark, Pat Showalter and many other mayors have welcomed presidents to Moffett Field—what a wonderful aspect of being mayor! Because of the ease of landing and departing Moffett Field (as well as security concerns) we imagine that this facility will continue to be used in the future.



Franklin Delano Roosevelt's entourage crosses the newly built Golden Gate Bridge on his 1938 San Francisco tour

Mountain View Mayor, Mike Kasperzak greets President Barack Obama at Moffett Field

History Happening Now

An Electrifying Weekend



Representative Anna Eshoo rides her new namesake CalTrain electric engine.

The weekend of September 21 & 22 was an "electrifying" two days Free rides allowed passengers to check out the new train system. Changing from diesel engines to an electrified power delivery system is a plan that took many years and a large budget to complete. The electric system will run from San Jose to San Francisco.

Celebration events were held in Mountain View, as well as other cities. On Saturday, Representative Anna Eshoo was the keynote speaker at the Mountain View event. In her speech she detailed the huge amount of planning and vision that it took to make such a significant change. Mayor Pat Showalter also spoke to the assembled crowd. To recognize the continued support of Anna Eshoo, an engine was named in her honor.

According to the CalTrain website; "The primary purpose of Caltrain Electrification is to improve Caltrain system performance and curtail long-term environmental impacts by reducing noise, improving regional air quality, and lowering greenhouse gas emissions." Benefits of the new train cars include free Wi-Fi, outlets at every seat, bathrooms, and digital displays with trip information.

Because electric trains can accelerate and decelerate faster and easier, they will provide more frequent service and improved travel times— the trip to San Francisco will be less than an hour. Trains will run more frequently (about every 30 minutes), including weekends. During commute hours additional trains will be added.

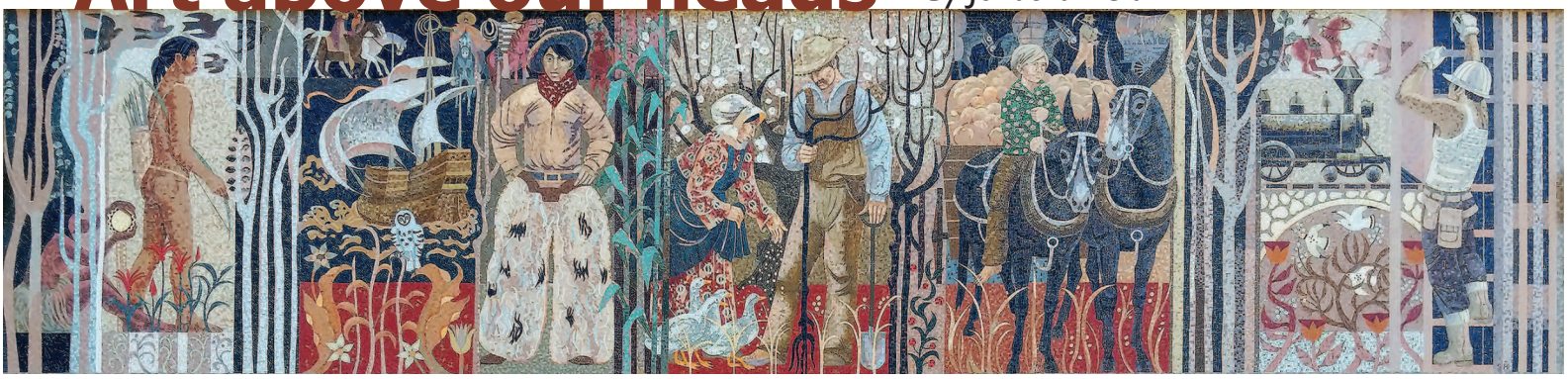
Annually, the change from diesel to electric is the equivalent of taking 55,000 cars off the road (250K metric tons of carbon dioxide).

Express, limited and full service trains will be available at the downtown Castro Street location. The San Antonio station will offer limited and full service.
https://www.caltrain.com.

This year the Peninsula is celebrating 160 years of train service. From a coal powered engine service that was a two hour trip to an electric system that offers a journey of less than an hour—that's an "electrifying" change.

Art above our heads

by Jonathan Clark



For over forty years drivers on El Camino Real have been lucky to be able to view a wonderful piece of public art. The privately owned but readily seen piece is the mosaic panel above the Chase Bank at the corner of Castro Street and El Camino Real. Thousands of cars pass daily — but how many of us have carefully looked at this incredible artwork?

The Chase Bank building at the intersection of El Camino Real and Castro Street, originally the location of Home Savings and Loan, was initially proposed in 1975. The building was designed and ornamented by artist Millard Sheets and Associates, as part of the savings bank empire founded by Howard Ahmanson. This remarkable collaboration between artist and financier resulted in over 160 buildings throughout California and other states, decorated by the Sheets studio and widely acknowledged today as landmarks of art created for public enjoyment but funded by private enterprise.

The story of California artist Millard Sheets and his evolution from plein-air watercolorist to design studio impresario is well documented. The collaboration with Home Savings began in 1954, and by the early 1970s the Sheets studio was creating what is regarded as their finest work. Their signature mosaic murals were individually researched for each location to reflect local history, and this is particularly true for the Mountain View building.

While the project was under review by the City Council, Millard Sheets personally attended meetings and offered modifications based on suggestions from planning director Glen Gentry. The mosaic itself, while incorporating some standard themes, was specifically adapted to reflect Mountain View's particular historical development.

The mosaic panel was designed by a woman artist, Susan Lautmann Hertel, principal collaborator (and former student) of Sheets and eventual president of Millard Sheets Design, Inc. The mural bears her signature, and her initials can be discerned at the lower right edge of the mosaic.

The bank building opened in 1977. Local newspapers carried articles about the new building and the wonderful mosaic on the front. Home Savings was acquired by Washington Mutual in 1998. Ten years later JP Morgan Chase became the successor and operates the bank location today.

The property where the bank is located is slated for redevelopment into a commercial and residential mixed-use project. The current plans call for preserving and reinstalling the mosaic (and the artwork inside the bank) in the new project.

Summer Event Recap

THE HISTORY OF PUBLIC SAFETY IN MOUNTAIN VIEW

PROTECTING OUR COMMUNITY

A large crowd attended our annual ice cream social on August 4, 2024. The topic was "Protecting our community- the history of public safety in Mountain View" at the Community Center, which allowed for the display of a large fire truck and a full-size police cruiser. Robert Maitland from the Fire Department and Doug Johnson of the Police Department presented a detailed account of the history of each organization.



THE 1920 MOUNTAIN VIEW FIRE DEPARTMENT

On April 1, 1874, the "Mountain View Station Hook & Ladder Co. No. 1" was formed when 50 of the town's civic minded residents gathered at the "Rogers & Rogers" Department Store. The organization was an all-volunteer effort. In 1905 a resolution was passed to create a more "formal" volunteer fire department. Just a year later the 1906 earthquake occurred, which damaged the town's water system and led to the expansion of the group. As the town and surrounding areas grew, additional equipment and volunteers were added.

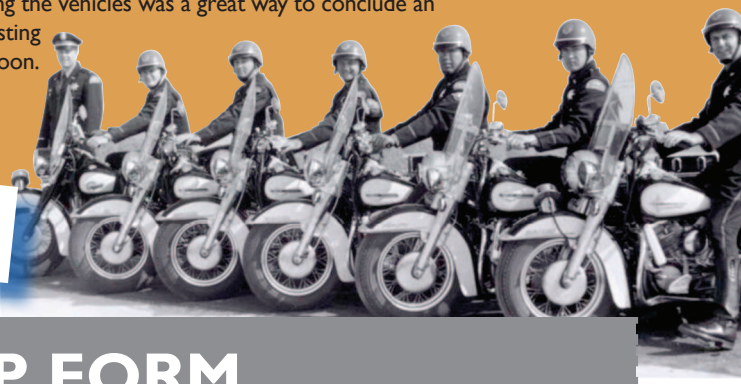
In 1964 the volunteer organization was disbanded, and the Fire Department became a paid professional organization. Today the Fire Department operates five stations and has a paid staff of over 80 people. The Fire Department provides rescue and EMS aid as well as assisting other nearby fire departments in special conditions. The organization also provides CERT training for interested residents.

The Mountain View Police Department was formed after the city was incorporated in 1902. For many years it consisted of a single officer. In 1909 the first dedicated City Hall building was erected. It housed the police department and included a jail cell, in addition to city offices and the library.

The first dedicated police station was built at 947 Villa Street in 1952. An 11-man department moved in, but by the time they relocated to the current station in 1980, the department had grown to over 100 officers and support staff. The current public safety building was constructed in 1978.

Today the Police Department employs over 140 individuals in a variety of specialties, such as traffic control, crisis negotiation, canine services, and detective work. Other staff members work in various administrative functions.

After the presentations people were invited to inspect the fire truck and police cruiser. Sitting in the driver's seat of the fire truck was a fun way to appreciate these large and complicated vital vehicles. The police vehicle is filled with a surprising amount of communication equipment. Viewing the vehicles was a great way to conclude an interesting afternoon.



THE 1964 MOUNTAIN VIEW POLICE FORCE

MEMBERSHIP FORM

The MVHA welcomes new members! You can also join/renew online at **www.mountainviewhistorical.org**. Membership is tax deductible to the extent permitted by law. The MVHA is a tax-exempt organization under Internal Revenue Code Section 501(c)(3), Tax ID 94-6115407.

- ☐ New Membership
- ☐ Membership Renewal
- ☐ Household Annual Membership *$30/year*
- ☐ Individual Lifetime Membership *$300*
- ☐ *I'm interested in volunteer opportunities*

Name(s) _____

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Mountain View Historical Association
c/o Lisa Garcia
P.O. Box 252
Mountain View, CA 94042

Thank you!

FALL WINTER

November 3, 2024
Sunday 2:00 pm to 4:00 pm
MVHA Fall History Event & Meeting
The History of Public Art in MV
Google Gradient building (see front page)

November 4 & December 9, 2024
MVHA board meetings
Wednesday 6:00 to 8:00
Virtual via Zoom
All interested members are welcome to attend!
Email info@mountainviewhistorical.org
for more information

November 24 & December 22, 2024
Sunday 2:00 pm to 4:00 pm
Downtown Walking Tour
Centennial Plaza
600 West Evelyn Avenue, Mountain View
Details at http://mvhistory.eventbrite.com

February 2, 2025
MVHA Winter History Event & Meeting
Innovators and Patent Holders of Mountain View
Sunday 2:00 pm to 4 pm
Location- TBD

Tentative: December 12
The Rich History of El Camino

Looking Back: Images from the Archives

A glimpse of the future arrived at Mountain View on March 19 ,1934. This sleek train was the M-10000, a three-car trainset, with a combined power/baggage/railway post office car and two trailing passenger coaches. The trainset was articulated, making the train operate as one integrated unit rather than as a separable locomotive and cars. It was the first streamlined passenger train to be operated in the United States. It was painted Armour Yellow on the sides with a Leaf Brown nose, roof, rear, and lower panels. Red striping separated the two main colors.

The trainset was delivered to Union Pacific on February 12, 1934, and was sent on a 13,000 mile publicity tour across the US. About a million people toured it and the stops became local media sensations. Called the "Streamliner" the trainset was operated by Union Pacific in revenue service between Kansas City, Missouri and Salina, Kansas. The trainset was retired at the end of 1941 and sold the next year as scrap for the war effort.



EST. 1954
MOUNTAIN REVIEW
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